THE ICE CRISIS

Is Now a Civil Rights Narrative

100% Negative Sentiment Globally

9.7M Potential Reach ICE / Pregnant Teens

17 Criminal Investigations Into ICE Agents

$426M New Detention Infrastructure

2 FATAL ICE SHOOTINGS — MINNEAPOLIS

WHAT THIS MEANS

The immigration debate has shifted into a government legitimacy crisis.

ICE sentiment and U.S. government trust now move together. (Observed from Talkwalker data.)

KEY INSIGHT

When enforcement actions target U.S. citizens, pregnant women, and minors — the framing shifts from policy debate to systemic legitimacy crisis.

SIGNAL

What Triggered This Analysis

01 Minneapolis ICE Shootings

- Renée Good, 37, U.S. citizen — shot three times
- Alex Pretti — second fatal shooting

02 State Criminal Investigations

- 17 investigations opened by Hennepin County
- Challenges to federal immunity claims

03 Pregnant Detainee Medical Cases

- Miscarriage after delayed medical care
- Solitary confinement during pregnancy

04 Federal Policy Shift

- Kristi Noem removed as DHS Secretary
- $426M in new detention expansion contracts

EVIDENCE

What the Data Confirms

LAW ENFORCEMENT ACTIVITY

17

Criminal investigations opened into ICE actions

ALLEGATIONS INCLUDE

- Excessive force
- Tear gas deployed near schools
- Violent arrests of civilians
- Two civilian deaths

DETENTION FACILITY DATA

MONTANA ICE CENTER

≈1

Emergency 911 call per day (Aug 2025 – Jan 2026)

REPORTS INCLUDE

- Suicide attempts
- Fights & altercations
- Medical neglect
- Overcrowding

At least 2 detainee deaths documented.

SENTIMENT DATA

How the Public Feels

NET SENTIMENT

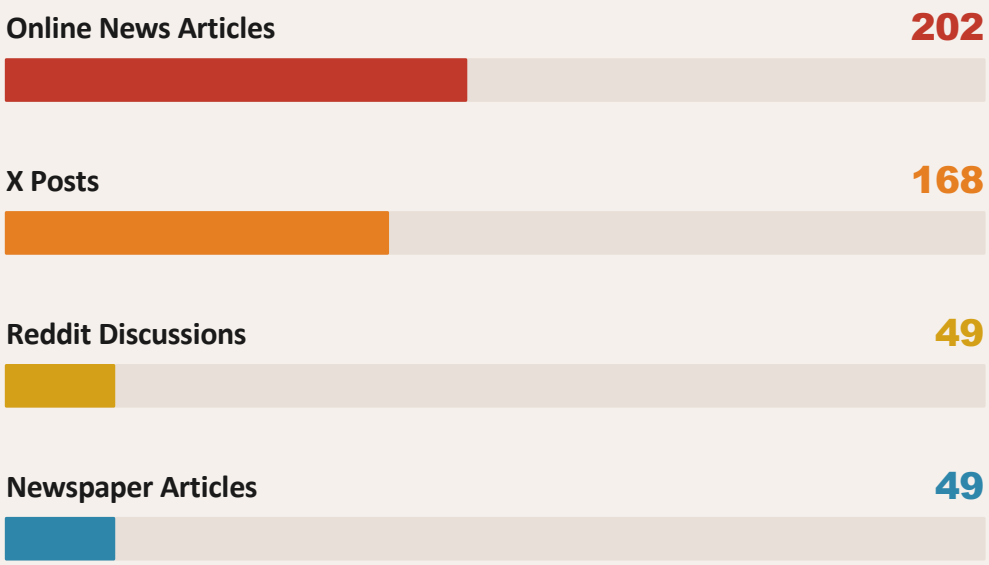
100%

NEGATIVE GLOBALLY

COUNTRIES WITH NEGATIVE SENTIMENT

- United States
- United Kingdom
- Canada
- Germany
- Spain
- India
- Australia
- Turkey
- Russia

CONVERSATION DISTRIBUTION



ONLINE NEWS REACH

1.6B POTENTIAL VIEWS

CASE STUDY

Pregnant Detainees

Three documented cases illustrate a systemic pattern

Alicia

Pregnant detainee

- Medical requests delayed
- Miscarried in custody
- Returned to detention same night

Marie

Legal visa holder

- High-risk pregnancy
- Placed in solitary confinement
- No prenatal care provided

Cary Lopez

9 months pregnant · U.S. citizen

- Detained during ICE raid
- Hospitalized following detention
- Documented civil rights case

Additional reports include pregnant minors as young as 13 years old in custody.

PATTERN

What the Data Shows

Three systemic patterns appear across all sources

01 Escalating Enforcement Intensity

- Fatal shootings of civilians
- State-level criminal investigations
- Surge operations in urban areas

02 Detention Expansion Without Safeguards

- $426M invested in new facilities
- Limited medical oversight in place
- Infrastructure outpacing accountability

03 Civil Rights Framing Replacing Immigration Framing

- Cases now involve U.S. citizens
- Pregnant women and minors detained
- Fundamentally changes the narrative

INSIGHT

Why This Is Happening

Four structural drivers explain the crisis

1 Enforcement Speed Prioritized Over Safeguards

Surge operations push agents to act faster than oversight systems can manage.

2 Detention Expansion Outpacing Medical Infrastructure

Facilities are expanding faster than staffing, medical care, and oversight can keep up.

3 Federal Immunity Gap

Agents claim federal immunity from state prosecution. Minnesota's investigations directly challenge this.

4 Narrative Transformation

Civilian casualties and pregnant detainees shift the issue from immigration policy to civil rights.

DISPLAYED VS. REALITY

The Narrative Gap

This gap is driving the surge in negative public sentiment

DISPLAYED NARRATIVE	PUBLIC SENTIMENT	OPERATIONAL REALITY
Border enforcement	*Human rights violations*	*Expanding detention system*
Crime prevention	*Government abuse*	*Increased enforcement intensity*
Immigration control	*Mistreatment of detainees*	*Accountability gaps*

The gap between these three realities is the engine of public distrust.

FINAL CONCLUSION & PREDICTIONS

What Happens Next

SHORT-TERM TRAJECTORY

The issue will continue shifting toward civil rights framing.

EXPECTED DEVELOPMENTS

- More state-level criminal investigations
- Greater media scrutiny of detention centers
- Growing criticism of ICE surveillance technology
- Continued decline in public trust of federal government

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION

ICE has become a symbolic proxy for trust in the federal government.

When enforcement intersects with:

- **U.S. citizens**
- **Pregnant detainees**
- **Medical neglect**

Public perception shifts from policy debate to systemic legitimacy crisis.